



Fairy chimneys

Otherworldly rocky spires jut out from the arid landscape of Cappadocia. These boulders were formed over millions of years by volcanic eruptions.



Hot-air balloons carry tourists over the Cappadocia rock formations so they can get a bird's-eye view.

The patterns, colors, and symbols of the rugs reflect local traditions and cultures.



Hand-woven carpets

Beautiful rugs and carpets called kilims have been made in Turkey for centuries.

Library of Celsus

The ancient site of Ephesus is located near Selçuk. Once a prosperous Roman city, its well-preserved ruins include this impressive 2nd-century library.



Grand Bazaar

Istanbul's famous bazaar is among the world's oldest covered markets. Its stalls sell everything from spices to jewelry.



Whirling dervishes

In Turkey, there are Muslim worshippers called dervishes who perform whirling dances, songs, and prayers to express their faith.



History: After the defeat of the Ottoman Empire in World War I, the Republic of Turkey formed in 1923.



Culture: The country's art and architecture reflect a unique mix of Eastern and Western influences.



Natural wonders: Grand sites include the clear green waters of the **Turquoise Coast** around Mugla and Antalya and the rare spires of **Cappadocia**.



Food and drink: From **kebabs** and **kofte** to **meze mixes**, Turkish dishes use ingredients from **Arab**, **Greek**, and **Western cuisine**.